

ANIMALS IN DANGER

⚠️ Of the 26 species, seven are critically endangered. Most species are decreasing in numbers. Threats vary, from poaching to pollution, but often involve human activities interfering with their natural habitats.

Different head shapes

The three types of crocodilians differ mainly in the shapes of their snouts: alligators and caimans typically have broader snouts than crocodiles, while the fish-eating gharials have the slenderest snouts of all, ending in a bulblike growth. Many crocodiles show exposed teeth in the lower jaw, even with their jaws closed.



Alligators and caimans



Gharials



Crocodiles

Alligator outpost

The only alligator outside of the Americas is the Chinese alligator, which lives on the northern edge of the tropics. It hibernates during the cooler months.

Mugger crocodile

The mugger lives in the shallows of wetlands on the Indian subcontinent. It burrows underground to escape the fiercest heat of the sun.

Gharial

The gharial from mainland Asia, and the false gharial from islands further south, spend more time in water than other crocodilians. They specialize in hunting for fish and, sometimes, frogs.

Saltwater crocodile

The world's largest crocodilian is also the most salt-tolerant. "Salties" often swim in coastal ocean waters, and have spread across a wide range of islands in Asia and Australasia and Oceania.

Crocodilians

The world's biggest reptiles live wherever it is warm enough for them to hunt and raise a family—by rivers and lakes in tropical regions on both sides of the equator. They are divided into three groups: alligators and caimans, crocodiles, and gharials.



THE **NUMBER OF TEETH** OF A **GHARIAL**—MORE THAN ANY OTHER CROCODILIAN

THERE ARE **FEWER THAN 80** ADULT **CHINESE ALLIGATORS** LEFT IN THE WILD